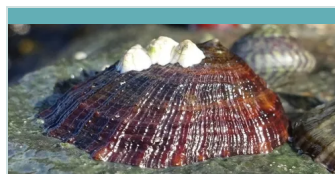


Species cards — review sheet

Colour, A6 double-sided, one deck per following page (8 cards, grouped by workshop table for printing only). Front is identification: photo, name, scientific name, one-line description, verified size and where it lives. Back is the food web: what it eats and what eats it, as sourced bullets, plus a QR to that species' own guide page.

For review. The print artwork is the separate 4-up A6 file. Every photo is a real, print-safe (CC0 / CC-BY / CC-BY-SA) image showing the live animal in water or on natural substrate — none hand-held or out of habitat — each checked with Gemini vision for whole-body visibility (see the build log for scores). Size and diet are mirrored from the verified species-guide data (PR #152): each diet bullet was read from a published account, and the card shows as many as fit, with the full list one QR scan away.



Common Limpet

Patella vulgata

Grazes algae off bare rock, always returning to the same spot

Size Shell up to 6 cm long, 5 cm wide and 3 cm high

Lives Rocky crevices

(c) Jamie O'Neill, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



T2 Grazer / filter feeder

I EAT

- A wide range of micro-organisms and algae, grazed straight off the rock
- Wrack germlings and other young seaweed sporlings, cropped before they can establish

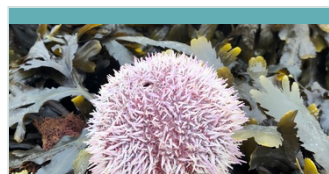
EATS ME

- Oystercatchers, which take limpets from rocky shores and feed them to their chicks
- Crabs, taking limpets that have been knocked off or have lost their grip on the rock



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Edible sea urchin

Echinus esculentus

Britain's largest sea urchin, grazing kelp and rock algae

Size Up to 15 to 16 cm in diameter, largest recorded 17.6 cm; about 9 to 11 cm at four years old

Lives Rocky crevices and the kelp canopy
(c) Ron Pasieczna, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via manual



T2 Grazer / filter feeder

I EAT

- Seaweeds grazed off the rock, with kelps such as Laminaria a preferred food
- Encrusting animals scraped off the rock, including barnacles, hydroids, bryozoans and sea squirts

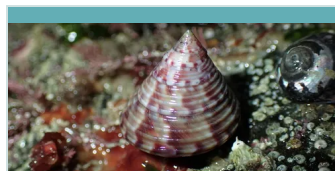
EATS ME

- European lobsters, which may prey on it
- Wolf-fish, which may take it in the north
- European shags, whose diet samples at a northern UK roost held this urchin in 27% of samples



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Painted Top Shell

Calliostoma zizyphinum

A glossy, cone-shaped shell marbled in pink and white

Size Shell up to 3 cm (30 mm) high and 3 cm broad

Lives Rocky crevices and the kelp canopy

(c) Julien Renoult, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



T2 Grazer / filter feeder

I EAT

- Micro-algae and other micro-organisms brushed off rocks and stones with the radula
- Micro-organisms and waterborne particles trapped in the mucus it wipes over its own shell, about a fifth of its food

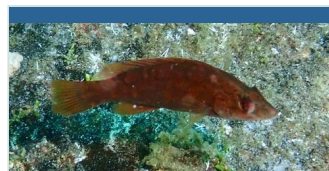
EATS ME

- Ballan wrasse, which take it among the gastropods eaten alongside their main crab and mussel prey
- Veined squid, recorded as a predator from prey identified in squid stomach contents



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Ballan wrasse

Labrus bergylla

A stocky wrasse that crushes shellfish with strong teeth

Size Up to 65.9 cm long, commonly 30-50 cm

Lives Rocky crevices and the kelp canopy

(c) jeyre, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



T4 Predator

I EAT

- Crabs and other decapod crustaceans, a major prey group in Irish, Breton and Azorean gut studies

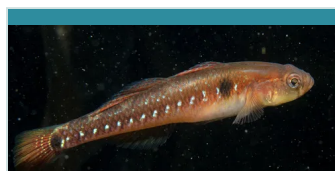
EATS ME

- Grey seals, whose scats around Scotland yield ballan wrasse otoliths
- Cormorants, which at sea feed mainly on bottom-dwelling fish, wrasses and codfishes over rocky, weed-covered ground



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Two-spotted goby

Gobiusculus flavescens

Hovers in loose midwater groups near kelp, unlike most gobies

Size Up to 6 cm total length

Lives The kelp canopy and open midwater

(c) Bernard Pictou, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Small crustaceans: copepods, amphipods and mysids
- Zooplankton, including planktonic copepods and arrow worms (chaetognaths); it is primarily a planktivore

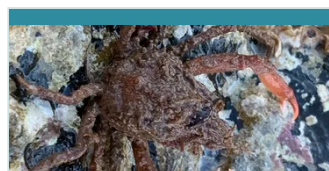
EATS ME

- Gadoid fish: cod, pollack, saithe and poor cod, which feed on it most heavily from July to December
- Squid, which take it among the small fish in their prey



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Spider Crab

Majoidea

Decorates its shell with seaweed and hydroids for camouflage

Size Body up to 20 cm long; carapace to 200 mm in males and 175 mm in females; the great spider crab's carapace up to 10 cm long

Lives The kelp canopy and rocky crevices and the open sand

(c) Ian Manning, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via manual



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- A scavenger on most seabed types, taking carrion, encrusting animals and seaweed
- Juveniles forage on algal-invertebrate turf in shallow nursery grounds through their first two years

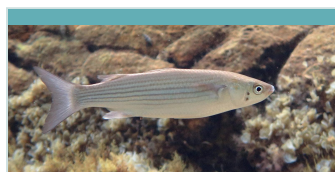
EATS ME

- Atlantic cod, which take spider crabs among their bottom-living crustacean prey
- Small-spotted catshark, recorded taking the great spider crab off England and Wales



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Thick-lipped mullet

Chelon labrosus

A silver mullet that cruises near the surface in schools

Size Up to 70-75 cm, commonly around 32 cm

Lives Near the surface and the open sand

Roberto Pillon, CC BY 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via manual



T2 Grazer / filter feeder

I EAT

- Benthic diatoms and epiphytic algae, and seaweeds grazed off the bottom
- Detritus and debris
- Small seabed invertebrates, chiefly amphipods, ostracods and small snails; juveniles feed only on zooplankton

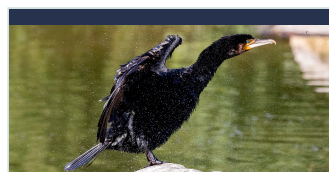
EATS ME

- Fish-eating seabirds, in particular the great cormorant
- Wading shore birds, in particular the grey heron



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Great cormorant

Phalacrocorax carbo

Dives for fish, then dries its wings held open on rocks

Size Length 80-100 cm, wingspan 121-160 cm, weight 2-3.7 kg

Lives Coastal cliffs and rocky shores, diving inshore to hunt

Alexis Lours, CC BY 2.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikipedia



T5 Apex predator

I EAT

- Almost entirely fish, mostly under 20 cm long, occasionally up to 75 cm
- At sea mainly bottom-living fish: wrasses and codfishes over rock and weed, flatfish over soft ground

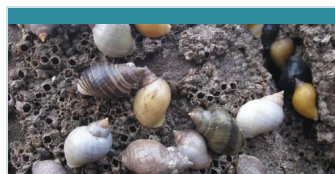
EATS ME

- Gulls and crows take eggs and chicks at nesting colonies, mostly where a colony has been disturbed
- Fledglings are taken by eagles, including white-tailed eagle, and by red foxes



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Dog Whelk

Nucella lapillus

Drills through mussel and barnacle shells to feed

Size Shell usually up to 3 cm high and 2 cm broad, reaching 6 cm in a few exceptional populations

Lives Rocky crevices

Martin Talbot, CC BY 2.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikimedia



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Mainly barnacles and mussels, the sessile animals that hold space on a rocky shore
- Cockles, other bivalves and other sea snails, taken less often

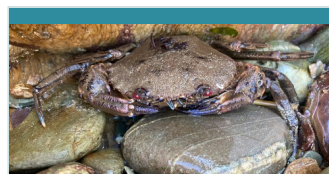
EATS ME

- Gulls and eider ducks swallow adults whole, and oystercatchers have caused heavy winter mortality; whelks of 4 cm or more are probably safe from birds



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Velvet Swimming Crab

Necora puber

A red-eyed crab with paddle-shaped back legs for swimming

Size Carapace up to about 8 cm across; males 78-96 mm wide, females 68-92 mm

Lives Rocky crevices and the kelp canopy

(c) Nick Butcher, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Brown algae, which makes up much of the diet in shallow water, with the animal share of it rising with depth

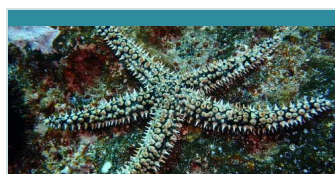
EATS ME

- Seabirds such as the European shag, for which this was the most frequent prey at a Shetland roost through the non-breeding season
- Fish, including adult sea bass, which take it on the continental shelf



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Spiny Starfish

Marthasterias glacialis

Britain's largest starfish, with spines ringed in blue

Size Up to 70 cm across, commonly 25-30 cm

Lives Rocky crevices and the open sand

(c) jeyre, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Mussels above all: the most-taken prey item at every depth on shallow rocky reefs, and preferred over urchins and snails in feeding trials

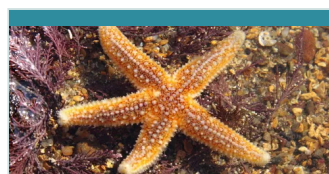
EATS ME

- Other starfish: the seven-armed starfish and the sunstars are recorded predators, and the common starfish also takes it as prey



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Common Starfish

Asterias rubens

The familiar orange starfish, often found near mussel beds

Size Up to 52 cm in diameter, commonly 10-30 cm

Lives The open sand and rocky crevices

(c) Darren Obbard, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Bivalve molluscs, prised open with the tube feet and digested by turning the stomach out into the shell
- Polychaete worms, other echinoderms and the occasional small crustacean, all taken alive

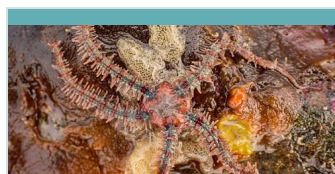
EATS ME

- The common sun star, a predatory starfish this animal turns and moves away from when it detects one
- Young Atlantic cod, recorded taking Asterias starfish among their seabed prey off Scotland



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL



Common Brittlestar

Ophiothrix fragilis

Carpet the seabed in dense beds of thin, fragile arms

Size Disk up to 2 cm across, with five arms about five times the disk diameter; 11-20 cm overall

Lives Rocky crevices and the open sand

(c) Lou Wagstaffe, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



T2 Grazer / filter feeder

I EAT

- Phytoplankton, diatoms and fine detritus taken from the water
- Suspended particles strained from the current with the arms held up into the water

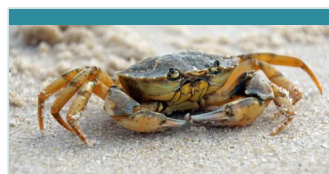
EATS ME

- Bottom-feeding fish, including ballan and cuckoo wrasse, dragonets, cod and plaice
- Crabs, especially swimming crabs such as the velvet crab



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Shore Crab

Carcinus maenas

Britain's commonest crab, found on almost every shore

Size Shell (carapace) commonly 4-8 cm wide, with males recorded to 86 mm across

Lives Rocky crevices and the open sand

Jürgen Hamann, CC BY-SA 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- A true omnivore, taking molluscs, other crustaceans, worms, algae and carrion
- Large crabs feed mainly on molluscs, with the common mussel the single most important prey

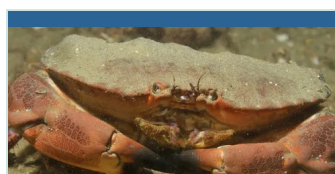
EATS ME

- Mainly fish and birds, including gulls, cormorants and eider ducks, and otters in some areas
- Atlantic cod, which take shore crabs among their bottom-living crustacean prey



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Edible Crab

Cancer pagurus

A broad crab with a crimped, pie-crust shell edge

Size Carapace width up to 25 cm, typically up to 15 cm

Lives Rocky crevices and the open sand

Olivier Dugornay (Ifremer), CC BY 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikimedia



T4 Predator

I EAT

- A variety of live molluscs and crustaceans, as well as carrion
- Crustaceans such as shore crabs, porcelain crabs and squat lobsters, and smaller crabs of its own kind

EATS ME

- Fish such as cod and wolffish, which it is thought to avoid by being mainly nocturnal
- Seals, which take crabs and hunt by sight
- Conger eels, recorded taking edible crabs off Ireland



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Common eider

Somateria mollissima

Britain's heaviest duck, diving for mussels near the farm

Size Length 55-60 cm, wingspan 94 cm, weight about 2.2 kg; the UK's heaviest duck

Lives Sheltered rocky coasts, diving for mussels

Andreas Trepte, CC BY-SA 2.5 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



T5 Apex predator

I EAT

- Blue mussels and other bivalve molluscs, taken on dives
- Crabs and other crustaceans
- Echinoderms, with some aquatic insects and small fish

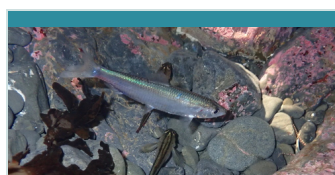
EATS ME

- Great skuas (bonxies), which take adult females at and near the nest
- Large gulls and great skuas (bonxies), which take many young chicks



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Sprat

Sprattus sprattus

A small shoaling baitfish and prey for almost everything else

Size Up to 16 to 25.1 cm, commonly about 12 cm

Lives Open midwater and the open water

(c) Jacob Littlejohn, some rights reserved (CC BY-SA) · CC-BY-SA · via iNaturalist



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Planktonic crustaceans, including copepods
- Cladocerans and other small planktonic crustaceans
- Other zooplankton, including arrow worms and larvaceans

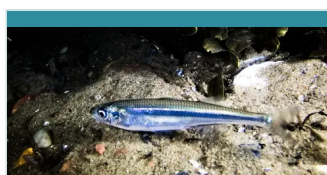
EATS ME

- Larger predatory fish, including cod, whiting, saithe, hake and gurnards
- Seals and small cetaceans, including harbour seal, harbour porpoise and bottlenose dolphin



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Sand smelt

Atherina presbyter

A slender, silver-striped fish that shoals near the surface

Size Up to 20 cm, usually 12 to 16 cm

Lives Near the surface and the open sand

(c) Klaus Kevin Kristensen, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via manual



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Zooplankton, including small planktonic crustaceans
- Fish eggs and larvae

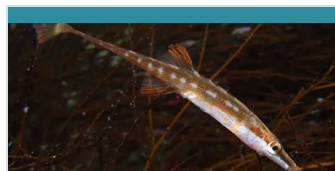
EATS ME

- Great cormorants, for which sand smelt is an important estuarine prey in southern Europe



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Fifteen-spined stickleback

Spinachia spinachia

Hovers almost motionless, camouflaged among kelp fronds

Size Up to 25 cm long, with a maximum recorded standard length of 22 cm

Lives The kelp canopy

(c) Vsevolod Rudyi, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via iNaturalist



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Small invertebrates, recorded for both juveniles and adults
- Bottom-living crustaceans, including isopods and barnacles
- Planktonic crustaceans, especially mysid shrimps and copepods

EATS ME

- Harbour porpoise (*Phocoena phocoena*)



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Poor cod

Trisopterus minutus

A small cod relative with one chin barbel and large eyes

Size Commonly about 20 cm total length, with reported maxima of 26 to 40 cm

Lives Open midwater and rocky crevices

Julien Renoult, CC BY 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikipedia



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Bottom-living crustaceans, including shrimps and prawns, crabs and hermit crabs, amphipods and mysids
- Small fish, including sandeels, gobies and dragonets
- Polychaete worms taken off the seabed

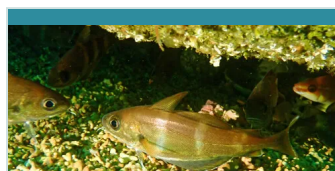
EATS ME

- Larger predatory fish such as cod, whiting, hake and turbot
- Grey and harbour seals, which commonly take poor cod in Scottish waters
- Conger eel and anglerfish



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Bib

Trisopterus luscus

A banded cod relative that shoals densely near wrecks

Size Up to 46 cm total length, commonly around 30 cm; adults usually 20-30 cm

Lives Rocky crevices and open midwater

(c) Donald Davesne, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via iNaturalist



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Bottom-living invertebrates are its main food, above all benthic crustaceans such as shrimps and prawns, crabs, amphipods and mysids
- Small fish, including sandeels, herring, sprat and gobies

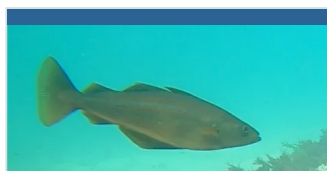
EATS ME

- Larger predatory fish and rays, including anglerfish, European hake, grey gurnard and thornback ray
- Marine mammals: harbour seal and bottlenose dolphin



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Pollack

Pollachius pollachius

A mid-water hunter with a sharply kinked lateral line

Size Up to 130 cm total length, commonly about 75 cm

Lives Open midwater and the kelp canopy and rocky crevices

(c) celliddeep, CC BY via iNaturalist · CC-BY · via manual



T4 Predator

I EAT

- Open-water shoaling fish: sandeels, herring, sprat and capelin
- Deep-sea prawns and shrimps; juveniles feed mainly on crustaceans among inshore rocks and weed

EATS ME

- Seals, which take pollack from gillnets and tangle nets; one study estimated 18% of pollack landings were depredated



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



Atlantic cod

Gadus morhua

A heavy-bodied cod with three dorsal fins and a chin barbel

Size Up to 200 cm total length, commonly around 100 cm; mature fish are usually about 120 cm and 12 kg

Lives Open midwater and the open sand

Hans-Petter Fjeld, CC BY-SA 2.5 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikipedia



T4 Predator

I EAT

- Fish, especially herring, capelin, sandeels and haddock, including smaller cod
- Crabs, hermit crabs, shrimps and prawns taken off the seabed

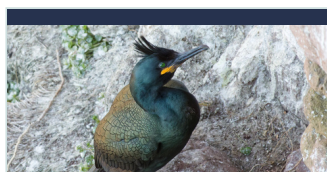
EATS ME

- Seals and small cetaceans, including grey seal, harbour seal and harbour porpoise
- Larger predatory fish, including whiting, saithe, monkfish and spurdog, and bigger cod eating smaller ones



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

PEBL pebl-cic.co.uk



European shag

Phalacrocorax aristotelis

A dark diving bird that can stay underwater for 20-40 seconds

Size Up to about 80 cm long, wingspan 90-105 cm, weight about 1.75-2.25 kg

Lives Sea cliffs and rocky ledges, diving close inshore

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T5 Apex predator

I EAT

- Almost exclusively small fish, caught by diving and pursuing them underwater; sandeels dominate in many populations, with gadoids such as saithe more important further north

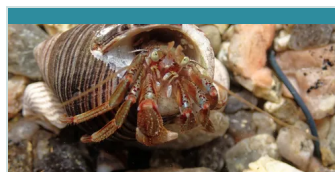
EATS ME

- Introduced American mink, which reach the birds at some nesting colonies



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Hermit Crab

Pagurus bernhardus

Lives inside a borrowed whelk or periwinkle shell

Size Carapace up to 35 mm long, the whole animal up to 4 cm, often looking larger because of the shell it carries

Lives The open sand and rocky crevices
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T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- An omnivorous scavenger, taking organic detritus and carrion off the seabed
- Sifts the sediment surface as a deposit feeder, and can also strain suspended particles from the water

EATS ME

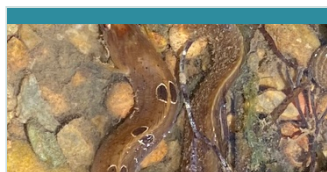
- Bottom-feeding fish of the cod family, including cod, whiting and pouting
- Gurnards and the lesser-spotted catshark, which hunt over the open seabed



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Butterfish

Pholis gunnellus

A slippery, ribbon-like fish with dark eye-spots along its fin

Size Up to 25 cm long

Lives Rocky crevices and the open sand

(c) Morgan Caygill, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via iNaturalist



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Small crustaceans
- Polychaete worms
- Molluscs and fish eggs

EATS ME

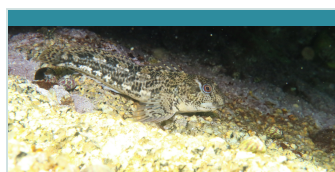
- European shag, which takes gunnells at a North Sea colony, where they occurred in 8% of diet samples
- Atlantic cod, with recruit and juvenile fish recorded eating rock gunnells in Scottish waters



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Shanny

Lipophrys pholis

A tubby blenny that darts in and out of rockpool crevices

Size Up to 16-17 cm total length, and up to 10 years old

Lives Rocky crevices

(c) Julien Renoult, CC BY 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via manual



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Small benthic invertebrates, especially gastropods, barnacles and amphipods
- Limpets and other molluscs, along with crabs, polychaete worms and isopods
- Algae, eaten alongside its invertebrate prey

EATS ME

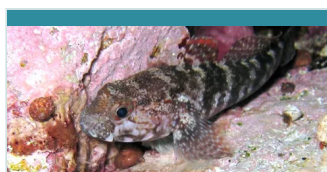
- Recorded as prey of the serranid fish *Serranus atricauda* in the Azores



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Rock goby

Gobius paganellus

A goby with fused pelvic fins that form a sucker

Size Up to 12 to 13 cm, mature at about 6 to 7 cm

Lives Rocky crevices

Roberto Pillon, CC BY 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikipedia



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Crustaceans, especially larger amphipods, isopods and small crabs
- Polychaete worms and other macrobenthos gleaned from hard substrates

EATS ME

- Common cuttlefish, which feeds on gobies, sandeels, whiting and wrasses
- The lizardfish *Synodus saurus*, recorded preying on this species in the Azores



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Common Octopus

Octopus vulgaris

A muscular octopus with two rows of suckers on each arm and a strong, shell-opening beak

Size Total length to 1.3-1.8 m; mantle length to 40 cm, commonly around 25 cm; weight to over 20 kg

Lives Rocky crevices and the open sand
albert kok, CC BY-SA 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikipedia



T4 Predator

I EAT

- Crustaceans, especially crabs and lobsters
- Shelled molluscs, drilled open through the shell to reach the animal inside
- Fish, when it can catch them, and polychaete worms

EATS ME

- Fish, including groupers, wrasses and eels, as well as sharks
- Marine mammals, especially dolphins and seals
- Other cephalopods, including its own species; cannibalism is recorded



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Conger eel

Conger conger

A large eel, usually seen only as a head peering from a crevice

Size Up to 275-300 cm total length and 110 kg, commonly 100-200 cm

Lives Rocky crevices

Holger Krisp, CC BY 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikipedia



T4 Predator

I EAT

- Bony fish taken at night, from whiting, poor cod and dragonet to flatfish such as plaice and dab

EATS ME

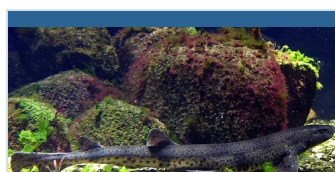
- Grey seals, whose scats in Scottish waters contain conger eel otoliths
- Common octopus, which is recorded with conger eel among its prey



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Lesser-spotted catshark

Scyliorhinus canicula

A small, spotted shark that curls up on the seabed

Size Up to about 75 cm, commonly around 60 cm; a 100 cm record may be a misidentification of a close relative

Lives The open sand and rocky crevices
Ernstia, CC BY-SA 2.5 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikipedia



T4 Predator

I EAT

- Crustaceans, including krill, true crabs and hermit crabs, plus shrimps taken close to the seabed
- Molluscs and small cephalopods picked off the bottom

EATS ME

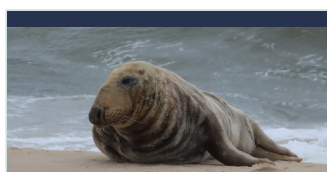
- Atlantic cod, recorded taking it in British waters
- Other small-spotted catsharks, with cannibalism recorded in all three length classes at 0.1% of stomach volume



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Grey seal

Halichoerus grypus

Britain's larger seal, with a long, straight 'Roman nose'

Size Adults up to about 2.3 m long; males over 300 kg, females around 150-200 kg

Lives Rocky shores and skerries, hauled out between dives

(c) Katie Gipson, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via iNaturalist



T5 Apex predator

I EAT

- Sandeels, typically the predominant prey species
- Gadoids, including cod, whiting, haddock and ling
- Flatfish such as plaice, sole, flounder and dab, and cephalopods

EATS ME

- A few specialist adult male grey seals, which kill and eat pups and juveniles
- Killer whales; their predation may be linked to the predicted decline in pup production in Shetland



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Sea potato

Echinocardium cordatum

An urchin that lives buried in sand and is rarely seen alive

Size Up to 9 cm long, usually about 4 to 6 cm

Lives The open sand

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T2 Grazer / filter feeder

I EAT

- Detritus, the dead organic matter mixed through the sand it lives in
- Sediment particles taken indiscriminately, both from the surface and from well below it

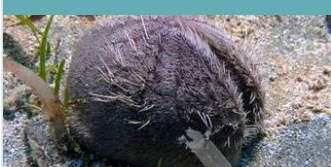
EATS ME

- Plaice, which take it among the soft-sediment prey they pick off sandy ground
- Gulls, which take the shallowest-burrowed animals when extreme low spring tides put them within reach



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Purple heart urchin

Spatangus purpureus

A larger heart urchin that ploughs shallow trails through sand

Size Up to 12 cm long and 8 cm across

Lives The open sand

Rpillon, CC BY-SA 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



T2 Grazer / filter feeder

I EAT

- Organic detritus, taken both from the surface of the sediment and from within it
- Spatangid heart urchins feed omnivorously on phytodetritus, faunal detritus and bacterial mats

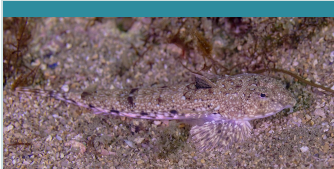
EATS ME

- The large comb star *Astropecten aranciaceus*, its principal predator



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Dragonet

Callionymus lyra

A sand-dwelling fish; males display a tall dorsal fin

Size Up to 30.5 cm total length (females to 25 cm), commonly about 15 cm

Lives The open sand

Diego Delso, CC BY-SA 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Mainly polychaete worms
- Amphipods and other small bottom-living crustaceans
- Molluscs, especially cockles

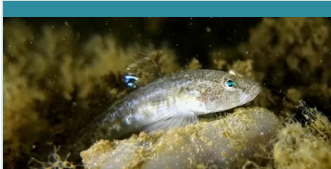
EATS ME

- Bony fish such as cod, pouting, conger eel and anglerfish
- Skates and rays, and the spurdog
- Marine mammals: grey and harbour seals and harbour porpoise



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Sand goby

Pomatoschistus minutus

A pale, near-transparent goby that blends into sand

Size Up to 10-11 cm long, mature from about 4-6 cm

Lives The open sand

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T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Small bottom-living crustaceans, chiefly amphipods, mysids and cumaceans
- Small polychaete worms taken from the sand and mud
- Fish eggs and larvae, including the young of its own species

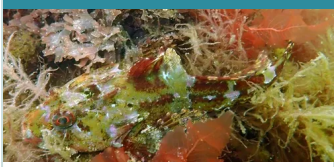
EATS ME

- Gadoid fish, especially cod and whiting
- Flatfish, including plaice and flounder
- Fish-eating birds and marine mammals, including harbour seal and harbour porpoise



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Long-spined sea scorpion

Taurulus bubalis

An armoured ambush predator camouflaged against rock

Size Up to 25 cm (females) and 17.5 cm (males), commonly about 12 cm

Lives Rocky crevices and the kelp canopy

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T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Small crustaceans: mysids, amphipods (gammarids) and decapods such as crabs and shrimps
- Fish, taken by ambush in shallow water and rockpools

EATS ME

- Grey seals, in whose scats sea scorpion is among the commonly recovered prey species
- Harbour seals in the Wash, whose winter diet includes sea scorpion among the scorpion fish taken



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Plaice

Pleuronectes platessa

A flatfish with bright orange spots scattered across its back

Size Up to 100 cm, though 50-60 cm is the usual limit and exceptional fish reach 90 cm; commonly around 40 cm

Lives The open sand

NasserHalaweh, CC BY-SA 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Bottom-living shellfish, particularly cockles and razor shells, and thin-shelled molluscs generally; young fish take bivalve siphon tips protruding from the seabed

EATS ME

- Grey seals, for which plaice is a significant part of the diet, and other marine mammals including harbour seal and harbour porpoise



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Flounder

Platichthys flesus

A flatfish that tolerates fresh water and enters rivers

Size Up to 60 cm, commonly around 50 cm

Lives The open sand

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T3 Planktivore / invertivore

I EAT

- Infaunal invertebrates dug from mud and sand: bivalves such as cockles and mussels, polychaete worms and crustaceans
- Small fishes, taken alongside the invertebrate prey once the fish is grown

EATS ME

- Seals and porpoises: grey seal, harbour seal and harbour porpoise are all recorded taking it
- Fish-eating birds, including cormorant, grey heron and goosander



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Harbour seal

Phoca vitulina

Smaller than the grey seal, often hauled out in a curved pose

Size 1.2 to 2 m long and 65 to 140 kg, adults typically 80 to 100 kg; males slightly bigger than females

Lives Sandbanks and sheltered shores, hauled out between dives

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T5 Apex predator

I EAT

- A wide range of fish: sandeels, gadoids, herring and sprat, and flatfish, with the mix varying by season and region
- Cephalopods: octopus and squid

EATS ME

- Grey seals, whose adult males prey on adult harbour seals, most of all during the breeding season
- Sharks, killer whales and polar bears



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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